



PSPF Release 2026 – Changes Summary

A summary of the changes introduced in PSPF Release 2026 is provided below.

Governance Domain

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
Section 1.2.1	Protective Security Directions	N/A	Added list of Protective Security Directions to date.
Section 3.5.1	Training on Foreign Interference, Espionage, Cultivation and Exploitation by Foreign Powers	0219	Security awareness training covers foreign interference, espionage, cultivation and exploitation by foreign powers.

Risk Domain

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
Section 7.1.5	Protecting Personal Information Online	0050	Personnel do not publicise their security clearance level information on online social media platforms, including employment-focused platforms such as LinkedIn.
Section 7.2.1	Prohibiting Publication of Security Clearance Information	0220	A specific policy prohibiting personnel from publicising security clearance information, and information indicating or alluding to their access to security classified information or resources, on online platforms is established.

Information Domain

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
Section 9.3.1	Protections and Handling Requirements for Physical information – Travelling Outside of Australia (international travel)	Table 8	SECRET – Airline Travel Not recommended. If required, retain as carry-on luggage in an official diplomatic bag that is properly marked and sealed, with appropriate accompanying official documentation, and retain in the custody of a laissez-passer, Australian Diplomatic or Australian Official passport holder. If airline requires carry-on baggage to be checked at the gate, do not travel.
Section 9.3.2	Protections and Handling Requirements for Government-issued	Table 9	Discuss: Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security

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	Mobile Devices – Inside Entity Facilities		Classified Discussions for approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.2	Protections and Handling Requirements for Government-issued Mobile Devices – Working Remotely in Australia (including home-based work)	Table 10	Discuss: Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security Classified Discussions for approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.2	Protections and Handling Requirements for Government-issued Mobile Devices – Working Remotely Internationally	Table 11	Relocate – PROTECTED Not recommended. If required, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and conduct entity must do a risk assessment of the proposed work environment and apply 'travel' outside Australia requirements.
			Relocate – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Yes, entity must seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and conduct a risk assessment of the proposed work environment, apply entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk.
			Use – PROTECTED Not recommended. If required, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and ensure international location meets all PSPF requirements for PROTECTED information.
			Use – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Yes, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice apply entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk. Use screen protectors where required, lock the screen when not in use and shut down device at end of each day.
			Discuss Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security Classified Discussions for approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.2	Protections and Handling Requirements for Government-issued Mobile Devices – Travel Outside of Australia (international travel)	Table 13	Travel – TOP SECRET No, do not travel with mobile device. Seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice on options to access mobile device at international destination.
			Travel – SECRET Not recommended. Apply DFAT Cyber Outreach advice on country-specific travel and Seek DFAT

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			advice on options to access mobile device at international destination. Travel – PROTECTED Not recommended. Apply DFAT Cyber Outreach advice on country-specific travel and Seek DFAT advice on options to access mobile device at international destination. If required, apply 'carry' outside entity requirements and any additional entity travel procedures, and consider country-specific travel advice. Travel – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Not recommended. Apply DFAT Cyber Outreach advice on country-specific travel and options to access mobile device at international destination. Yes, apply 'carry' outside entity requirements, any additional entity travel procedures, and consider country-specific travel advice. Air travel luggage – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Not recommended. If required, retain as carry-on luggage. If airline requires carry-on baggage to be checked at the gate, do not travel. Yes, apply 'carry' outside entity requirements, any additional entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk. Leave unattended – OFFICIAL: Sensitive No, do not leave unattended. Not recommended. If required, apply entity procedures, exercise judgement to assess environmental risk, and consider country-specific travel advice. Store while travel – OFFICIAL: Sensitive No, do not store while travelling (e.g. in hotel room). If required, can be stored in Australian entity facility meeting 'store' inside entity requirements. Yes, apply 'store' outside entity requirements and consider country-specific travel advice.
Section 9.3.2	Protections and Handling Requirements for Government-issued Mobile Devices – Provided at International Destination	Table 14	Discuss: Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security Classified Discussions for approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.3	Protections and Handling Requirements for Non-Government Mobile Devices – Inside Entity Facilities	Table 15	Discuss – PROTECTED, OFFICIAL: Sensitive and OFFICIAL Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security Classified Discussions for

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
			approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.3	Protections and Handling Requirements for Non-Government Mobile Devices – Working Remotely in Australia (including home-based work)	Table 16	Discuss – PROTECTED, OFFICIAL: Sensitive and OFFICIAL Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security Classified Discussions for approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.3	Protections and Handling Requirements for Non-Government Mobile Devices – Working Remotely Internationally	Table 17	Relocate – PROTECTED Not recommended. If required, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and conduct a risk assessment of the proposed work environment. and apply 'travel' outside Australia requirements.
			Relocate – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Yes, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and conduct a risk assessment of the proposed work environment. Apply entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk. apply entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk.
			Use – PROTECTED Not recommended. If required, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and ensure international location meets all PSPF requirements for PROTECTED information.
			Use – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Yes, seek DFAT Cyber Outreach advice and exercise judgement to assess environmental risks, apply entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk. Use screen protectors where required, lock the screen when not in use and shut down device at end of each day.
			Discuss – PROTECTED, OFFICIAL: Sensitive and OFFICIAL Yes, on mobile device applications authorised to operate up to a specific security classification and encrypted in accordance with ASD standards and guidance. See Security Classified Discussions for approved locations for security classified discussions.
Section 9.3.3	Protections and Handling Requirements for Non-Government Mobile Devices – Travel	Table 19	Travel – PROTECTED Not recommended. Apply DFAT Cyber Outreach advice on country-specific travel and Seek DFAT advice on options to access mobile device at

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	Outside of Australia (international travel)		international destination. If required, apply 'carry' outside entity requirements and any additional entity travel procedures, and consider country-specific travel advice. Travel – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Not recommended. Apply DFAT Cyber Outreach advice on country-specific travel and options to access mobile device at international destination. Yes, apply 'carry' outside entity requirements, any additional entity travel procedures, and consider country-specific travel advice. Air travel luggage – OFFICIAL: Sensitive Not recommended. If required, retain as carry-on luggage. If airline requires carry-on baggage to be checked at the gate, do not travel. Yes, apply 'carry' outside entity requirements, any additional entity procedures and exercise judgement to assess environmental risk. Leave unattended – OFFICIAL: Sensitive No, do not leave unattended. Yes, apply entity procedures, exercise judgement to assess environmental risk, and consider country-specific travel advice. Store while travel – OFFICIAL: Sensitive No, do not store while travelling (e.g. in hotel room). If required, can be stored in Australian entity facility meeting 'store' inside entity requirements. Yes, apply 'store' outside entity requirements and consider country-specific travel advice.
Section 9.7	Recordkeeping Metadata Standard	0068	The Australian Government Recordkeeping Metadata Standard's 'Security Classification' sub-property (and where relevant, the ' Security Caveat ' Text and ' Caveat Type ' sub-property) is applied to protectively mark information on technology systems that store, process or communicate security classified information.
Section 12.3	International Information Sharing	0081	Australian Government security classified information or resources bearing the Australian Government Access Only (AGAO) caveat is not shared with a person who is not an Australia citizen, even when an international agreement or international arrangement is in place, unless they are working for, or seconded to, an entity that is a member of the National Intelligence Community, the Department of Defence, the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade , or the Australian Submarine Agency.

Technology Domain

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
Section 13.4.2	TikTok Application	0091, 0092	Requirements retired and replaced by PSPF Requirement 0221.
Section 13.5	Commonwealth Technology Standard	0221	The Australian Government Commonwealth Technology Standard and its annexes are applied when authorising technology systems to operate up to SECRET.
Section 13.6	Centralised Risk Sharing Capability	0222	A policy that considers sharing risk assessments of products, applications and web services to the Centralised Risk Sharing Capability is established.
Section 13.10.2.2	Post-Quantum Cryptographic Algorithms	0212	Approved post-quantum cryptographic encryption algorithms are used for supported on newly procured cryptographic equipment and software in accordance with the Information Security Manual's guidelines for cryptography.
Section 13.10.2.3	Planning to Transition to Post-Quantum Cryptography	0223	A post-quantum cryptography transition plan is developed, implemented and maintained.
Section 15.2.1	Hosting Certification Framework	0111	Security classified or systems of government significance information and data is securely hosted using a Cloud Service Provider and Data Centre Provider or Data Centre Service that has been certified against the Australian Government Hosting Certification Framework or the Australian Government Hosting Certification Framework 2.
Section 15.2.2	Data Centres	0112	The Data Centre Facilities Supplies Panel is used when procuring certified data centre space and services.
Section 15.3	Gateway Security	0214	Digital infrastructure that processes, stores or communicates Australian Government OFFICIAL and security classified information is protected by a Gateway capability or Security Service Edge in accordance with the Australian Government Gateway Security Standard.
		0114	Gateways or Secure Service Edges capabilities that have completed an IRAP assessment (or ASD assessment for TOP SECRET gateways) against the latest version of ASD's Information Security Manual within the previous 24 months are used.

Personnel Domain

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
Section 17.1	Temporary Access to Resources	N/A	Temporary access is not granted to systems that process, store or communicate caveated information, irrespective of the security classification of the information.
Section 17.1.3	Limit Duration of Temporary Access	0125	Amended applicability to 'AVA'
Section 17.3.1.2.	Working in Another Government Entity's Facilities in Australia (Hosted or Co-location Arrangements)	0135	A security risk assessment of the proposed location and work environment informs decisions by the Chief Security Officer to allow personnel to work in another government entity's facilities in Australia.
Section 18.4	Sponsoring Security Clearances	0144	Amended applicability to 'AVA'
Section 18.6	Eligibility Waivers	N/A	New policy content on Concurrent Eligibility Waiver Exceptional Circumstances
Section 18.6.1	Citizenship Eligibility Waiver	0148	The Sponsoring Entity establishes an exceptional business need and conducts a risk assessment in accordance with the Australian Government Personnel Security Adjudicative Standard and its annexes, before a citizenship eligibility waiver is considered for a non-Australian citizen who has a valid visa and work rights to work in an identified position.
		0149	The Accountable Authority (or the Chief Security Officer if delegated) approves a citizenship eligibility waiver (after accepting the residual risk of waiving the citizenship requirement for that person, and confirming that a checkable background eligibility waiver is not in place), (unless an exemption has been established), and maintains a record of all citizenship eligibility waivers approved.
Section 8.6.2	Checkable Background Eligibility Waiver	0150	The Sponsoring Entity establishes an exceptional business need and conducts a risk assessment in accordance with the Australian Government Personnel Security Adjudicative Standard and its annexes (including seeking advice from the Authorised Vetting Agency), before a checkable background eligibility waiver is considered for a clearance subject assessed as having an uncheckable background.
		0151	The Sponsoring Entity's Accountable Authority (or the Chief Security Officer if delegated) approves checkable background eligibility waivers (after accepting the residual risk of waiving the checkable background requirement for each

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
			person, and confirming that a citizenship eligibility waiver is not in place), (unless an exemption has been established) , a (unless exceptional circumstances have been established), and maintains a record of all checkable background eligibility waivers approved.
Section 22.3	Post-Separation Security Clearance Actions	0188	Amended applicability to 'AVA'

Physical Domain

Location	Subject	Requirement or Table	Change
Section 24.1	Security Zones	Table 38	Added SCIF content.
Section 24.2.2	Sensitive Compartmented Information Facilities	0199	Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility (SCIF) areas are used to secure and access TOP SECRET systems and Sensitive Compartmented Information and security classified compartmented information are accredited by the Australian Signals Directorate in accordance with the National SCIF Accreditation Program before they are used operationally.

Contact

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